

Folder Creation Procedure

Document Information

Document Title: Folder Creation Procedure

Project: Organize a Professional Digital Filing System

Document Type: Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to provide a standardized method for creating folders and subfolders within the Professional Digital Filing System. Following this procedure ensures that documents are stored in a logical, consistent, and scalable folder hierarchy that supports efficient document management and retrieval.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to the creation of all folders and subfolders used within the Professional Digital Filing System, including folders for administration, finance, projects, school work, books, personal files, backups, archives, and documentation.

3. Responsibilities

The user creating the filing system is responsible for:

- Creating folders according to the approved folder hierarchy.
- Using consistent folder names.
- Maintaining the established folder structure.

- Avoiding unnecessary or duplicate folders.
 - Reviewing the structure periodically as new requirements arise.
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4. Folder Naming Standards

When creating folders:

- Use clear and descriptive names.
- Capitalize major words consistently.
- Use numbers where required to maintain order.
- Avoid special characters such as:

\ / : * ? " < > |

- Avoid vague names such as:

New Folder
Folder1
Misc
Stuff

5. Main Folder Structure

The Professional Digital Filing System should contain the following main folders:

Professional Digital Filing System

```
|
|— 01 Administration
|— 02 Finance
|— 03 Human Resources
|— 04 Projects
|— 05 Clients
|— 06 Reports
|— 07 Correspondence
|— 08 Legal Documents
|— 09 Templates
|— 10 Archive
|— 11 School
|— 12 Books
|— 13 Certifications
|— 14 Portfolio
|— 15 Personal
|— 16 Media
|— 17 Software
|— 18 Downloads
|— 19 Backups
```

6. Folder Creation Procedure

Method 1: Create a Folder Using File Explorer

Step 1: Open File Explorer

Press:

Windows + E

or click the **File Explorer** icon on the taskbar.

Step 2: Navigate to the Location

Browse to the location where you want to create the new folder.

Example:

Documents

or

Professional Digital Filing System

Step 3: Create a New Folder

Choose one of the following methods:

Method A

- Right-click inside the window.
- Select **New**.
- Click **Folder**.

Method B

On the toolbar, click **New** and then **Folder**.

Method C

Press the keyboard shortcut:

`Ctrl + Shift + N`

A new folder will be created.

Step 4: Name the Folder

Type the approved folder name immediately.

Example:

`04 Projects`

Press **Enter** to save the name.

Method 2: Create Multiple Subfolders

If the main folder already exists:

1. Open the folder.
2. Create each required subfolder using **Ctrl + Shift + N**.
3. Name each subfolder according to the approved structure.

Example:

```
04 Projects
├── Active Projects
├── Completed Projects
├── Documentation
├── Screenshots
├── Templates
├── Sample Files
└── Presentation
```

Method 3: Create Subfolders Using the Address Bar

1. Open the parent folder.
2. Click the File Explorer **address bar**.
3. Type the full folder path using backslashes (\).

Example:

```
Documentation\Reports
```

Press **Enter**.

If the folders do not already exist, create them using **Ctrl + Shift + N**.

Method 4: Create Multiple Folders Using Command Prompt

Open **Command Prompt**.

Navigate to the required location and use the `mkdir` command.

Example:

```
mkdir "Reports" "Procedures" "Guides" "References"
```

This creates four folders at once.

Method 5: Create Multiple Folders Using PowerShell

Open **PowerShell**.

Run:

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Name  
"Reports","Procedures","Guides","References"
```

This creates all specified folders in the current directory.

7. Verify the Folder Structure

After creating folders:

- Confirm that all folders exist.
- Check that names are spelled correctly.
- Verify numbering is consistent.
- Ensure folders are in the correct location.

- Remove any unnecessary or duplicate folders.
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8. Folder Maintenance

Review the folder structure periodically.

When adding new folders:

- Follow the existing numbering system.
 - Use descriptive names.
 - Place folders in the appropriate category.
 - Update related documentation if necessary.
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9. Best Practices

- Plan the folder structure before creating folders.
 - Keep folder names concise and meaningful.
 - Use numbered folders for major categories.
 - Avoid deeply nested folder structures where possible.
 - Maintain consistency throughout the filing system.
 - Review the structure regularly.
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10. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Using inconsistent folder names.
 - Creating duplicate folders.
 - Mixing unrelated documents in one folder.
 - Leaving folders with default names such as **New Folder**.
 - Creating folders outside the approved hierarchy.
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11. Related Documents

- Document Filing Procedure
- Procedure for Saving Files

- File Retrieval Procedure
 - File Backup and Recovery Procedure
 - Archive Management Procedure
 - Duplicate File Management Procedure
 - File Permission Management Procedure
 - Folder Structure Guide
 - User Guide
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12. Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	5 July 2026	Initial release.

13. Conclusion

A well-designed folder structure is the foundation of an effective digital filing system. By following this Folder Creation Procedure, users can create a logical, consistent, and scalable hierarchy that supports efficient document storage, quick file retrieval, and long-term maintenance. Consistent folder creation also ensures that the filing system remains easy to navigate and adaptable as new documents and projects are added over time.